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# After the destruction ban: the ecodesign data EU fashion buyers will ask Turkish suppliers for

The Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation already limits what brands can do with unsold clothes. Product rules and a digital passport for textiles come next.

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## Executive summary


1. Since 19 July 2026 large companies may no longer destroy unsold apparel, clothing accessories and footwear in the EU, under the Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation, Regulation (EU) 2024/1781. Medium-sized companies follow on 19 July 2030. Companies that still discard unsold consumer products must publish what they discarded and why.
2. The Commission's ESPR working plan schedules ecodesign requirements for textiles and apparel for 2027. They are expected to cover durability, recycled content and substances, and to bring a digital product passport that carries product data along the value chain.
3. For a Turkish garment or textile supplier the effects arrive through the brand. Buyers who can no longer destroy overstock will order closer to demand and push for smaller, faster runs. Buyers who will need a product passport will ask for fibre, origin, processing and chemical data per model. The suppliers who can give that data cleanly will be easier to keep.


## What has changed

Regulation (EU) 2024/1781 entered into force on 18 July 2024. It is a framework: product-specific requirements are set by delegated acts, group by group. Two of its rules already apply directly, without waiting for those acts.

The first is the ban on destroying unsold consumer products listed in Annex VII, which today covers apparel, clothing accessories and footwear. It has applied to large enterprises since 19 July 2026 and will apply to medium-sized enterprises from 19 July 2030; micro and small enterprises are excluded. Commission Delegated Regulation (EU) 2026/296 sets the limited cases in which destruction is still allowed, such as health, safety or hygiene grounds, or products that infringe intellectual property.

The second is transparency. Large companies, and later medium-sized ones, that discard unsold consumer products must disclose each year how many products they discarded, why, and how, on a freely accessible webpage.

Product rules for textiles are next. The ESPR working plan adopted in 2025 places textiles and apparel among the first product groups, with delegated acts planned for 2027. The rules would apply some time after adoption and are expected to include information requirements delivered through a digital product passport.

Separately, Directive (EU) 2025/1892 requires EU member states to set up extended producer responsibility schemes for textiles and footwear by 17 April 2028, so brands will also pay fees linked to the products they place on the market.

## The decision behind the requirement

For a supplier, the destruction ban is a planning question before it is a compliance one. Brands carry the overstock risk now, so they will try to share it: smaller initial orders, more replenishment, tighter delivery windows and more returns of unsold stock for rework or resale. Suppliers who can run short, reliable cycles gain; those built only for long runs lose margin.

The product passport is a data question. Fibre composition, recycled content, country of each processing step, chemical compliance and durability test results will need to sit at model level and travel with the product. Much of this data already exists in Turkish mills and factories, but scattered across purchasing records, lab reports and subcontractors.

A supplier that organises this data once, in a structure brands can import, turns a compliance cost into a reason to stay on the approved list.

## Five common misreadings

“The ban is the brand’s problem.” It applies to the economic operator that discards the goods, but its effect on order patterns reaches every supplier. Turkish groups with EU retail, warehousing or subsidiaries should also check whether they are in scope directly.

“We can wait for the textile delegated act.” Building model-level data across subcontractors takes longer than the gap between adoption and application is likely to be.

“The passport is a QR code on the label.” The code is only the carrier; the value is in the data behind it, which must be accurate and maintained.

“Only large brands are affected.” Medium-sized companies follow in 2030, and buyers of every size will pass data requests down the chain.

“This is separate from forced labour and chemicals rules.” Traceability for the Forced Labour Regulation, PFHxA limits under REACH and passport data rely on the same supply-chain information.

## Questions for the leadership team

1. Which of our EU customers are large or medium-sized enterprises under the ESPR, and how are their ordering patterns changing?
2. How much of our production is made against firm orders, and how much against forecasts that could leave unsold stock?
3. Can we run smaller, faster replenishment cycles profitably?
4. Do we hold fibre composition, recycled content and origin data at model level?
5. Which processing steps are subcontracted, and do we know where each one happens?
6. Where are our chemical test reports and durability results kept, and in what format?
7. Which customers have already asked about product passports or ecodesign data?
8. Would one data structure serve passport, forced labour and chemicals requests together?

## What a good first step produces

A useful first step is a product data and order-pattern review for the customers and product lines that carry most of your EU sales. It should show which data each buyer will need, where it sits today, and how ordering changes could affect capacity and margin.

Ganrich Advisory runs this with your sales, planning and quality teams, and coordinates with testing laboratories and software providers where they are needed. We do not certify products. We share the working method in a conversation rather than in print, because it depends on the product range.

### Start a conversation

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**About this paper.** This paper reflects official sources checked on 24–25 October 2026. It is general information, not legal, customs, tax or engineering advice. Rules, thresholds and dates change; confirm them against official sources before acting. It describes no client work or results.

**Sources:** Regulation (EU) 2024/1781 on ecodesign for sustainable products: eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2024/1781/oj · Commission Delegated Regulation (EU) 2026/296 on derogations from the destruction ban: eur-lex.europa.eu · European Commission, Ecodesign for Sustainable Products Regulation: commission.europa.eu/energy-climate-change-environment/standards-tools-and-labels/products-labelling-rules-and-requirements/ecodesign-sustainable-products-regulation_en · Directive (EU) 2025/1892 on textile extended producer responsibility: eur-lex.europa.eu

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